

Kathy Reid-Naiman makes children's music so accessible that some adults secretly confess to listening to it just for themselves. Her songs bring the comfort of tradition and the sweetness of nostalgia – as well as the thrill of novelty and innovation to young listeners, and their caregivers too. This is her 17th CD of songs and fingerplays for very young children. Many of her recordings have been included in Newborn Literacy Kits distributed by Early Years Centres and Library Associations to families in many Canadian provinces in an effort to encourage parental involvement in early learning and literacy.

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Spring Is Coming

Kathy Reid-Naiman

1. Spring is Coming - Kathy Reid-Naiman © SOCAN 2013
This song came after a really long winter that featured an ice storm that lasted for a few days and left our front steps covered in 2 feet of ice.

I can feel the sun shining, shining, shining all around
I can feel the sun shining, all around.
Spring is coming and the sun is shining all around.
I can see the snow melting, melting, melting all around
I can see the snow melting, all around.

Spring is coming and the snow is melting and the sun is shining all around.
I can hear the birds singing, singing, singing all around.
I can hear the birds singing, all around.
Spring is coming and the birds are singing and the snow is melting
And the sun is shining all around.

I can see the rivers flowing, flowing, flowing all around
I can see the rivers flowing all around.
Spring is coming and the rivers are flowing and the birds are singing
And the snow is melting and the sun is shining all around.

I can see the people smiling, smiling, smiling all around
I can see the people smiling all around.
Spring is coming and the people are smiling and the rivers are flowing
And the birds are singing and the snow is melting
And the sun is shining all around.

2. Mister Sun - unknown author

Oh Mister sun, sun, Mister golden sun,
Won't you please shine down on me.
Oh Mister sun, sun, Mister golden sun,
Hiding behind a tree.
These little children are asking you
Won't you please come out so we can play with you?
Oh Mister sun, sun Mister golden sun
Please shine down on me.
Shine, shine, shine, shine, please shine down on me.

3. Daffy-down-dilly - unknown author
Daffy-down-dilly has now come to town
In a yellow petticoat and a green gown.

Five Yellow Daffodils - © Kim Wallach Black Socks Press 2018

5 yellow daffodils blooming on a hill
Swaying in the breeze as daffodils will
Along came a child with scissors to say
I need that flower for my mamas bouquet. Snip
4,3,2,1
No yellow daffodils blooming on a hill
Swaying in the breeze as daffodils will
Along came a child who said "that's okay,
I've got enough flowers for my mama's bouquet."

4. Springtime Lullabye - Ken Whiteley ©Pair-a-dice music 2022 SOCAN
I asked Ken if he would like to write a song for this CD and this is the result…the essence of spring flowers!

Snowdrops are up, snowdrops are up
Little white flowers
The snowdrops are up
And I go down, I go down to sleep.

Crocuses are up, crocuses are up
Purple, gold flowers
The crocuses are up
And I go down, I go down to sleep

Tulips are up, tulips are up
Red, white, yellow
The tulips are up
And I go down, I go down to sleep.

5. Crocuses and Scilla - unknown author
This rhyme was adapted from 'Buttercups and Daisies' because those flowers don't bloom until early summer.

Crocuses and scilla
Oh what pretty flowers
Coming in the springtime
To tell of sunny hours
while the trees are leafless
While the fields are bare
Crocuses and scilla
Spring up everywhere.

6. Pussywillow - unknown author
This is a gentle song that uses the scale to gently build the suspense.

I know a little pussy
Her coat is silver grey
She lives down in the meadow
Not very far away

Although she is a pussy
She'll never be a cat
For she's a pussywillow
Now what do you think of that?
Meow, meow , meow, meow
Meow, meow, meow, Scat!

7. Dig a little Hole - unknown author

Dig a little Hole *(pretend to dig a hole)*
Plant a little seed *(plant seeds with one hand onto the other palm)*
Pour a little water, pull a little weed *(pour water on hand then pull out the weeds)*
Chase a little bug, *(shoo away bugs)*
Oh there he goes *(put hands above eyes to watch the bugs)*
Give a little sunshine *(put hands under chin fanned upwards to catch the sun)*
Smell a little rose. *(smell the rose)*

8. Seed in the Ground - ©Word of Mouth Connie Kaldor
This accumulative song is not only a beautiful song, it is also a fingerplay and a science lesson. The first part of the song repeats each time as a new part of the flower grows.

1. If you've got the sun and if you've got the rain
And you plant a little seed in the old back lane
And you wish and you hope and you keep the weeds down
You might find, oh, you might find: *(repeat this each time)*
A root growing out from the seed in the ground.

2. *(repeat the first part of the verse)*
A shoot growing up from the root, from the seed in the ground.

3. *(repeat the first part of the verse)*
A stem growing up from the shoot, from the root, from the seed in the ground.

4. *(repeat the first part of the verse)*
A bud growing up from the stem, from the shoot, from the root, from the seed in the ground.

5. *(repeat the first part of the verse)*
A flower growing up from the bud, from the stem, from the shoot, from the root,
from the seed in the ground.

6. *(repeat the first part of the verse)*
A seed growing up from the flower, from the bud, from the stem, from the shoot, from the root,
from the seed in the ground



9. The Wiggly Worm - unknown author

Under a stone or the earth was firm
I found a wiggly, wriggly worm.
"Good morning" I said
"And how are you today?"
But the Wiggly worm just wriggled away

10. I Had a Little Piggy - unknown author
Thank you Kate Jarrett for sharing this delightful fingerplay.

I had a little piggy *(make a fist with thumb sticking out – this is the piggy)*
And I fed him in the trough *(cup both hands to make a trough)*
And got so big
That his tail fell off *(spread arms wide then pop the tail off – thumb inside your fist)*
So I got a little hammer *(hammer on one palm)*
And I got a little nail *(and then the other)*
And I made my piggy a brand new tail. *(pop thumb out)*

I had two piggies and I fed them in the trough (same actions for two fists)
And they got so big that their tails fell off

11. Because It's Spring - unknown author
I learned this lovely song from Robin and Andy Davis.

The air is warm and the sky is blue
The leaves are green yellow because they're new
My feet go skipping the birds do sing
The whole world is happy because it is spring

12. Little Robin Redbreast - unknown author

Little Robin redbreast sat upon a rail
Niddle noddle went his ahead and wiggle went his tail.

13. Where are the Froggies? - unknown author

Thank you to Deirdre Murtha for sharing this song about hibernation and spring awakenings. The children can pretend to sleep and then when they awake they can act out
the animal actions.



Where are the froggies when the north winds blow?
We cannot see them in the ice and snow
Deep, deep down in their beds they lie
Little froggies with tight closed eyes.
But when the spring time sun comes out
Froggies wake and jump all about
Oh how happy they will be
A springtime world they then will see.

Where are the snakes when the north winds blow?
We cannot see them in the ice and snow.
Deep, deep down in their nests they lie,
Little snakes with tight closed eyes.
But when the spring time sun comes out
Snakes awake and slither all about.
Oh how happy they will be
A springtime world they then will see.

Where are the birdies when the north winds blow?
We cannot see them in the ice and snow.
Way down south where it's warm they fly
Little birdies stay nice and dry.
But when the spring time sun comes out
Birdies come home and they fly all about
Oh how happy they will be
A springtime world they then will see.



Where are the bears when the north winds blow?
We cannot see them in the ice and snow
Deep deep down in their dens they lie
Little bears with tight closed eyes
But when the spring time sun comes out
Bears awake and they stomp all about
Oh how happy they will be
A springtime world they then will see.

14. Hippity Hop - © Linda Morrison Heartstrung Music, SOCAN
When my children were young we listened to this on the Junior Jugband's LP.
It never gets old!

Springtime in the month of May
Old man winter's gone away
Froggy sits upon the ground
But pretty soon he's gonna hop around.

Chorus: The father frog goes hippity-hop
The mother frog goes hippity-hop
Once you start jumping you just can't stop
And the baby frog goes hop, hop, hop, Hop, hop, hop.

Jump as high as you can go
Jump it fast or jump it slow
Back-and-forth all around and round
As long as you go up and down.

Everybody hop on down
To the jumpingest party that can be found
Hop along in the big parade
The baby frog's gonna lead the way.

15. Jonny Porkpie - © Kathy Reid-Naiman 2019
A Porkpie hat is a flat-top hat with a wide brim. This is a knee bounce or joggle. For JVG.

Jonny Porkpie and Miss Clarissa Brown
Rode their buggy into town,
The little pony ran and he would not stop
Till Jonny and Clarissa fell down
Kerplop!

16. Pat-a-Cake - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2022
This is just a whimsical song based on the traditional rhyme. Ken and I had fun playing pat-a-cake …can you hear us?

Pat-a-cake, Pat-a-cake, baker's man
Pat-a-cake, Pat-a-cake, Give me your hand
Roll them up, roll them, up nice and sweet
Put them in the oven and then we'll eat.

17. Here Is a Baby Ready For Her Nap - unknown author

Here is a baby ready for her nap *(show index finger)*
Lay her down in her mama's lap. *(lay other hand out palm up and put baby on it)*
Cover her up so she won't peep *(fold fingers over baby)*
and rock her till she's fast asleep. *(rock her back and forth)*



18. Mama's Sleeping - unknown author
Thank you Cynthia Stenger for sharing this rhythm instrument song. I use it with sticks, shakers, bells, or whatever instruments we have. It's fun to pause between the quiet and loud verses to build suspense.

Mama's sleeping don't wake her up
Mama's sleeping don't wake her up
Mama's sleeping don't wake her up
She must be very tired

Wake up mama, it's time to play
Wake up mama, it's time to play
Wake up mama, it's time to play
Now we're very noisy
Papa, baby *(or whoever else might be trying to sleep)*

19. I Hear Thunder - unknown author

I see blue skies, I see blue skies
Way up high, way up high
Now I see a few clouds, only just a few clouds
Passing by, passing by.

I hear thunder, I hear thunder
Hark don't you, hark don't you
Pitter patter raindrops, pitter patter raindrops
I'm wet through, so are you.

I see blue skies, I see blue skies
Way up high, way up high
Look here comes the sunshine, look here comes the sunshine
We'll soon dry, we'll soon dry.

20. Puddles - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2021
Kids and puddles are a natural mix.



I'm going for a walk and I'm finding lots of puddles
Going for a walk on a rainy day
I've got my rubber boots and a big umbrella
Going for a walk in the month of May

Chorus: Splish splash, stepping in the puddles
Splish splash on a rainy day
Splish splash, I'm getting kind of muddy
Jumping in the puddles on a rainy day.

I'm going for a walk and I'm stepping in the puddles
Going for a walk on a rainy day
I've got my rain pants and my favourite raincoat
Going for a walk in the month of May

I'm going for a walk and I'm jumping in the puddles
Going for a walk on a rainy day
I've got a great big smile and I'm feeling very happy
Going for a walk in the month of May.

21. We're Jumping! - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2018
Face a partner holding both hands while jumping and following the actions. After bowing to your partner move around the room looking for a new friend to start the dance again.

We're jumping and jumping and here we go,
Shake your head nod your head and tap your toe,
Go round and around and around with your partner now
Say goodbye with a great big bow.



22. Ring Around My Rosy - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2020
I used part of my granddaughter's name in this singing game because I love 'Ring Around the Rosy' and I love her.

Ring around my Rosy, I love you *(one child in the middle while everyone circles)*
Ring around my Rosy, cock a doodle do ….

Here stands Rosy in a ring *(circle stops moving and 'Rosy' dances)*
She loves to dance and sing
She jumps up high, she bows down low
Hear the roosters crow . *(she chooses someone to join)*

Ring around my Rosy, I love you *(two children in the middle while everyone circles)*
Ring around my Rosy, cock a doodle do

Here's 2 Rosies in a ring *(circle stops moving and 'Rosies' dance)*
They love to dance and sing
They jump up high, they bow down low down low
Hear the roosters crow.

Ring around my Rosy, I love you *(they each choose someone to join)*
Ring around my Rosy, cock a doodle do

Here's 4 Rosies in a ring *(circle stops moving and 'Rosies' dance)*
They love to dance and sing
They jump up high, they bow down low down low
Hear the roosters crow.

23. See My Fingers - © Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2021
There's an old taunt that goes "See my fingers, See my Thumbs, See my fists you better run!" That has nothing to do with this fingerplay, I was just thinking about those words when I wrote it.

See my fingers, see my thumbs
See them and wiggle and see them run
Watch them dance up to the sky
Watch them flutter and watch them fly

24. What Do You Suppose / Bee Freeze
What Do You Suppose - unknown author

What do you suppose
A bee sat on my nose
And said "I beg your pardon
I thought you were the garden."

Bee Freeze - by Tina Stone
After talking to children about bees, this is a fun movement game to play. Walk around until the leader says Freeze! Stay frozen until the poem starts again.

If you see some buzzy, buzzy bees
Flying through the flowers and the trees,
Please don't scream or swat them please,
Just be like a statue and Freeze!

25. Mosquitos - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2022
I spend a lot of time in northern Ontario when the mosquitos are plentiful in the late spring. Count them with your fingers and then wiggle your fingers in the air and all around your head.
One mosquito two mosquitoes three mosquitoes four,
Buzzing all around my kitchen door.
Five mosquito six mosquito seven mosquitos eight
Buzzing all around my garden gate
Buzzy, buzzy all around my hat
Buzzy, buzzy, buzzy, buzzy ….Splat

26. Poor Little Sandy Girl - unknown author
I learned this singing game when my children were in a co-op nursery school. There are many versions of it.

Poor little Sandy Girl sitting on the shore *(one child sits in the centre of a circle)*
Crying, crying, till her eyes are sore *(pretending to cry)*
Stand up, Sandy girl wipe your tears away *(child stands up and wipes 'tears')*
Choose the one you like the best
And then go out to play. *(dances with a friend in the centre.)*
(the original child joins the circle and the game continues with the chosen one staying. You can change the name to Sandy Boy or use the child's real name.)

27. Ako Si Legla Spat - Croatian Klapa Lullabye
*It was such a joy to sing this with **Singing Through Life**. Thank you to Andy Davis and Mary Kay Brass for teaching me this beautiful song.*

Ako si legal spat, ako si legal spat
Ako si legal spat, Bila ti la kanoc.
When you lie down to sleep, when you lie down to sleep,
When you lie down to sleep, we wish you all goodnight.
Angels of paradise, Angels of paradise,
Angels of paradise, they will watch over you.

28. Close Your Eyes and Dream - Kathy Reid-Naiman ©SOCAN 2021

You've been up since break of day,
You've laughed and played your day away,
And now it's time for me to say,
Close your eyes and dream, close your eyes and dream.

Songs have been sung and stories read,
It's time to rest your sleepy head,
Now let's get you into to bed,
To close your eyes and dream, close your eyes and dream.

You've brushed your teeth; you've brushed your hair
Gave kisses to your teddy bear
And in this world you haven't a care so
Close your eyes and dream, close your eyes and dream.

Now baby's eyes are closed up tight
I hope she sleeps all through the night
And now I'll just turn out the light
And close my eyes and dream, close my eyes and dream



29. Tomorrow's Just a Dream Away/The Lullabye
© Anna and Dennis Soloway
Campers Week at Pinewoods Camp in Massachusetts is a magical woodland place where I have enjoyed singing and dancing with my children, (who are now grown up and taking their own children to) for almost 4 decades. Part of the evening routine is pied-pipering the youngest ones off to their cabins. Anna and Dennis wrote this for that purpose. It is a favourite!

When the day breaks I might go to sea
Or I might take a job in a button factory
Or I might fly to France where they all say Bon Nuit.
But tomorrow's just a dream away.

Chorus: Goodnight to you, goodnight to the moon
Goodnight to my family and goodnight to me.
By and by I'll see you in my dreams.

When the night falls, I might see the stars
Or I might see the fairies driving little fairy cars
Or I might hitch a ride on a moonbeam to Mars
But tomorrow's just a dream away.

Some dreams are big, and some dreams are small
And then sometimes you dream about nothing at all
Just remember each night when the shooting stars fal
That tomorrow's just a dream away



30. Thula - Traditional South African
*I was blessed to be a part of a hospice choir, **Singing Through Life**. We loved to sing this song as we left the presence of the person that we were singing to.*

Thula thula mtwana - Umama, umama uyeza
Uyo tenga maswiti - Khona seezo kudla
Thula, thula mtwana

Musicians:
Kathy Reid-Naiman: vocals, banjo Uke
Ken Whiteley: guitars, harmony vocals, piano, organ, tenor banjo, fretless banjo, banjo uke, autoharp, washboard, vibraphone and percussion including red-backed boinger.
Ben Whiteley: double bass and Cello
Chris Whiteley: trumpet and harmonica
John Showman: fiddle
Bucky Berger: drums
Arnie Naiman : banjo
Nicolas Tjelios : claves
Singing Through Life: Alan Gasser, Jennifer Wakefield, Leela Khurana, Neil Brandt, Ray Kinoshita, Kathy Reid-Naiman

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